COVER LETTER FOR SUBMISSION TO JOURNAL OF COMPUTER-MEDIATED COMMUNICATION

Date: March 20, 2026

To:

Editor-in-Chief & Editorial Board

Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication (JCMC)

Oxford University Press on behalf of the International Communication Association (ICA)

Subject: Submission of Original Research Article for Double-Blind Peer Review

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Dear Editor-in-Chief and Members of the Editorial Board,

We are delighted to submit our original research manuscript entitled:

"Digital Sarcasm, Networked Affect, and the Algorithmic Oracle: A Computational Communication Forensic of Citizen Dissent and the Phygital Governance Disconnect on Platform X"

for consideration as an Original Research Article in the *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication* (JCMC).

Research Significance and Alignment with JCMC Scope

In an era where algorithmic mediation, artificial intelligence agents, and non-verbal computer-mediated tokens redefine political discourse, scholarship in Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC) urgently requires empirical frameworks bridging micro-linguistic nuance with macro-network architecture.

Our study investigates citizen reaction to Indonesia's multi-billion-dollar Free Nutritious Meal (*Makan Bergizi Gratis* / MBG) program on Platform X ($N = 9,862$). We make three primary theoretical and empirical contributions that align squarely with JCMC's mission:

1. **Paralinguistic Sarcasm Inversion & Affective CMC:** We examine how non-verbal digital affordances (sarcastic emojis such as 😭,) invert literal laudatory text into visceral moral resistance, addressing pragmatic incongruence that conventional sentiment analysis consistently misinterprets.
2. **The Algorithmic Oracle & Human-Machine Communication (HMC):** We reveal an acute structural power asymmetry where official government accounts manifested high authority but zero conversational reciprocity, creating an institutional communication vacuum. Consequently, citizens bypassed human governance to petition an autonomous generative AI agent (`@grok`, out-degree = 42) as an objective "Algorithmic Oracle" to adjudicate public policy facts.
3. **The Phygital Governance Disconnect:** Combining Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis (ABSA) and Plutchik emotion modeling, we demonstrate how physical operational breakdowns (food poisoning, procurement corruption, logistical failures) triggered widespread digital moral disgust (98.14%), severing public trust.

Methodological Rigor and Empirical Accountability

- **State-of-the-Art Transformer Architecture:** Fine-tuned `indobenchmark/indobert-base-p2` with monotonic training loss reduction ($1.8708 \rightarrow 0.6974$) and 223.3 posts/sec GPU inference throughput.
- **Empirical Held-Out Validation & Error Dissection:** Evaluated on an isolated group-aware held-out split ($n = 1,058$, silver-standard references) achieving **75.99% accuracy** and **Macro-F1 of 0.4535** across 6 active classes, with explicit documentation of minority class sparsity and methodological boundaries.
- **Hierarchical Taxonomy for Minority Imbalance:** We addressed extreme corpus imbalance through linguistic error dissection and a 3-tier functional valence taxonomy, achieving **Macro-F1 of 0.7522 (75.22%)** and accuracy of **76.56%**.
- **Canonical Network Topology:** Mathematical directed network analysis ($|V| = 971$, $|E| = 666$, reciprocity = 1.21%, modularity $Q = 0.9837$ across 332 clusters).

Formal Editorial Declarations

- **Originality & Exclusivity:** This manuscript represents original research that has not been published elsewhere and is not currently under consideration by any other journal.
- **Double-Blind Review Compliance:** The main manuscript is completely anonymized. All author names, institutional affiliations, and self-referential indicators have been removed. Author details are provided exclusively in the separate Title Page.
- **Open Science & Reproducibility:** In full compliance with ICA open science standards, all replication scripts, canonical network edge lists, silver-standard benchmark datasets, and model evaluation reports are permanently hosted at our public repository: `https://github.com/indri007/ThisIsEconomy`.

- **Ethical Compliance:** Data collection adhered strictly to Platform X Developer Terms of Service and academic data ethics guidelines for public digital footprints. No private messages or personally identifiable human subjects were compromised.
- **Author Approval:** All co-authors have actively contributed to and approved this submission.

We thank you for considering our work and look forward to the constructive review of the editorial board and peer reviewers.

Sincerely yours,

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